Verified

UEFA Nations League

UEFA introduced the Nations League to replace many international friendlies with competitive league matches. The highest-ranked teams compete for a place in the Nations League Finals.

UEFA Nations League Finals, 2018-19 onward

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
2024–25	Germany	**Portugal**	Spain	France	Germany	2–2; Portugal 5–3 pens	8 June 2025	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Portugal beat Spain on penalties in the 2025 final to become the competition 's first two-time champion.

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
2022–23	Netherlands	**Spain**	Croatia	Italy	Netherlands	0–0; Spain 5–4 pens	18 June 2023	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Spain won the 2023 final on penalties after a goalless draw with Croatia.
2020–21	Italy	**France**	Spain	Italy	Belgium	France 2–1 Spain	10 October 2021	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Italy hosted the 2021 Finals without reaching the final itself, finishing third as France beat Spain 2–1 for the title.

Season	Finals host	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth	Final	Final date	Story
2018–19	Portugal	**Portugal**	Netherlands	England	Switzerland	Portugal 1–0 Netherlands	9 June 2019	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Portugal won the first-ever Nations League Finals in 2019, beating Netherlands 1–0 as hosts.

Podium by edition

2024–25

Hosted by Germany

🥇 **Portugal**
🥈 Spain
🥉 France
4. Germany

2022–23

Hosted by Netherlands

🥇 **Spain**
🥈 Croatia
🥉 Italy
4. Netherlands

2020–21

Hosted by Italy

🥇 **France**
🥈 Spain
🥉 Italy
4. Belgium

2018–19

Hosted by Portugal

🥇 **Portugal**
🥈 Netherlands
🥉 England
4. Switzerland

🏆 Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Portugal 2

2018–19, 2024–25

France 1

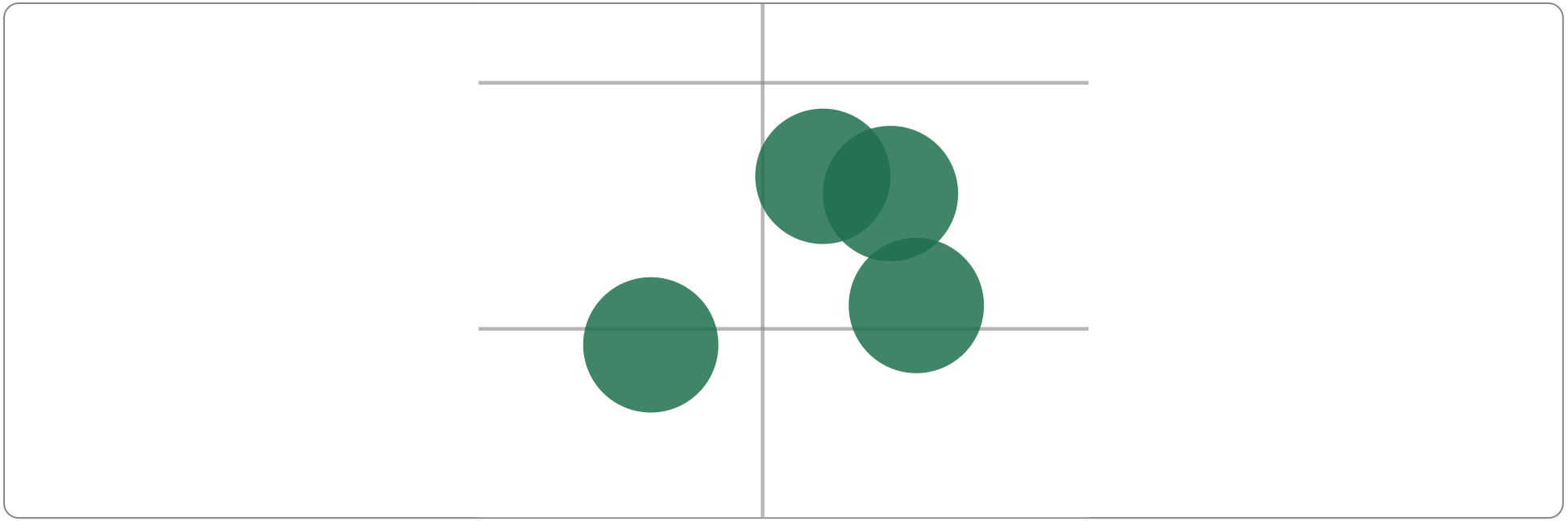
2020–21

Spain 1

2022–23

Where the tournament has been hosted

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



Europe

Portugal 1 time

2018–19

Italy 1 time

2020–21

Netherlands 1 time

2022–23

Germany 1 time

2024–25

ℹ️ How it works

- Every UEFA national team is placed into one of four leagues (A to D) by strength, then split into small groups within its league.
- Teams play each other in their group; results promote the best teams to a higher league and relegate the weakest to a lower one, alongside separate World Cup/EURO qualifying.

- The four League A group winners advance to the Nations League Finals: two semifinals, a third-place match, and a final, all hosted by one of the four finalists.
- Held every two years.

📝 Key facts

- Portugal won the inaugural edition.
- Portugal became the first two-time champion in 2025.
- Croatia reached its first Nations League final in 2023.
- The competition uses promotion and relegation between leagues.

📝 Final venues

- All four teams that reach the Nations League Finals host a semifinal, but only one stadium in the host nation stages the final itself. A reported attendance figure is added only where it could be confirmed via two independent sources that actually converge (2019 so far) - the other three editions' figures are left out rather than guessed, either because only one source reports a figure at all (2021) or because the sources found disagree too much to treat as confirming the same count (2025, see below).
- **2019:** Estádio do Dragão, Porto (Portugal) - a reported attendance of 43,199.
- **2021:** San Siro, Milan (Italy).
- **2023:** De Kuip, Rotterdam (Netherlands) - stepped in for the larger Johan Cruyff Arena in Amsterdam, which was unavailable because of a concert booking.
- **2025:** Allianz Arena, Munich (Germany) - two sources were found for this final but disagree by roughly 9,000: one reports 65,852, another separately reports a rounded "sold out" figure of 75,000. That gap is too wide to treat as the usual rounding/reporting variance between two sources describing the same count, so no figure is reported here either.

📝 Player of the Finals winners

- UEFA has named a best-player award at every Nations League Finals since the competition's 2019 launch, initially called "Player of the Tournament" before being renamed "Player of the Finals" from 2021 onward.
- **2019:** Bernardo Silva (Portugal).

- **2021:** Sergio Busquets (Spain).
- **2023:** Rodri (Spain).
- **2025:** Nuno Mendes (Portugal).

📝 Winning managers

- **2019:** Fernando Santos (Portugal).
- **2021:** Didier Deschamps (France).
- **2023:** Luis de la Fuente (Spain) - the same season he took charge of Spain, before also winning EURO 2024 and the 2026 World Cup with them.
- **2025:** Roberto Martínez (Portugal) - his first trophy since taking over from Fernando Santos.

📝 Winning captains

- The captain is the player who lifts the trophy on the podium; every Nations League Finals winner has had one across all four completed editions.
- **2019:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal).
- **2021:** Hugo Lloris (France).
- **2023:** Jordi Alba (Spain) - given the captaincy for the Finals by manager Luis de la Fuente.
- **2025:** Cristiano Ronaldo (Portugal) - the first captain to lift the Nations League trophy twice.

🎉 Memorable moments

- Portugal won the first-ever Nations League Finals in 2019, beating Netherlands 1–0 as hosts.
- Italy hosted the 2021 Finals without reaching the final itself, finishing third as France beat Spain 2–1 for the title.
- Spain won the 2023 final on penalties after a goalless draw with Croatia.
- Portugal beat Spain on penalties in the 2025 final to become the competition's first two-time champion.
- The host nation has finished in the Finals' top four in every edition so far, including Germany finishing fourth in 2025.

📚 References & review

Status: verified Last reviewed:18 October 2026

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- Final attendance, third re-investigation (added 2026-10-08, two-hundred- (source 2 of 3) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UEFA_Nations_League_final)
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- Whole-page third independent cross-check (2026-10-18, intensive run): with (source 1 of 8) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2023_UEFA_Nations_League_final)
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- Whole-page third independent cross-check (2026-10-18, intensive run): with (source 4 of 8) (https://www.channelstv.com/2021/10/10/france-beat-spain-to-win-nations-league/amp/)
- Whole-page third independent cross-check (2026-10-18, intensive run): with (source 5 of 8) (https://www.football-espana.net/2023/06/10/jordi-alba-message-nations-league-spain)
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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.